SELF-DIRECTED CASE STUDY · BUSINESS ANALYSIS & PRODUCT THINKING

Project Horizon

Replacing the system three departments quietly depend on

Vendor selection, from first interview to go-live sign-off, for a mid-size manufacturing and logistics company.



Nupur Sharma

A simulation: the company, people and vendors are fictional. The analysis and decisions are mine.

Project Horizon in 60 seconds

THE PROBLEM

A discontinued 2011 system runs two plants and three warehouses

Paper picking, no audit trail, one server with no failover.

THE APPROACH

The full BA lifecycle, end to end

Discovery, business case, RFP, scoring, requirements, UAT, rollout.

THE DECISION

Buy Warehouse360, not the cheapest vendor

The cheapest option failed a mandatory barcode requirement.

THE LEARNING

What I would change next time

Add real stakeholder conflict and real vendor quotes.

5	10	24	5	13
stakeholder voices	pain points catalogued	RFP requirements	options modeled	UAT test cases

A 2011 system running a 2026 business

14 hrs

longest unplanned outage, during a peak dispatch week

~25 hrs

a month Finance spends reconciling the system to Tally by hand

2+ weeks

to train one new warehouse hire on an undocumented interface

MERIDIAN AT A GLANCE (FICTIONAL)

- **2 manufacturing plants**
- **3 regional warehouses**
- **~120 users across 5 sites**
- **No vendor patches since 2021**

The risk was not only lost productivity. A single unsupported server made this a business-continuity problem.

Five voices, five definitions of broken



Rajiv Malhotra

Head of Operations

TOP PAIN

No single view of stock across three sites

NEEDS

Real-time dashboards



Sunita Rao

Finance Controller

TOP PAIN

Silent edits: no audit trail on adjustments

NEEDS

Tally sync, landed cost



Deepak Yadav

Warehouse Supervisor

TOP PAIN

Paper picking and timeouts at peak

NEEDS

Barcode and handhelds



Priya Nair

Procurement Manager

TOP PAIN

Requisitions live in email and spreadsheets

NEEDS

Approval flow, 3-way match



Arvind Kapoor

IT Manager

TOP PAIN

One server, no failover, no vendor support

NEEDS

SSO, API, resilience

Personas and interviews are simulated for this case study.

Five of ten pain points are high severity

PP-01
No cross-site stock view
Operations

PP-02
No audit trail on adjustments
Finance

PP-03
Manual Tally reconciliation
Finance

PP-04
Paper picking, no barcodes
Warehouse

PP-05
Slow at peak dispatch
Warehouse

PP-06
No PR-to-PO workflow
Procurement

PP-07
No 3-way invoice match
Procurement

PP-08
Single server, support ended
IT

PP-09
No SSO or role-based access
IT

PP-10
No landed-cost calculation
Finance

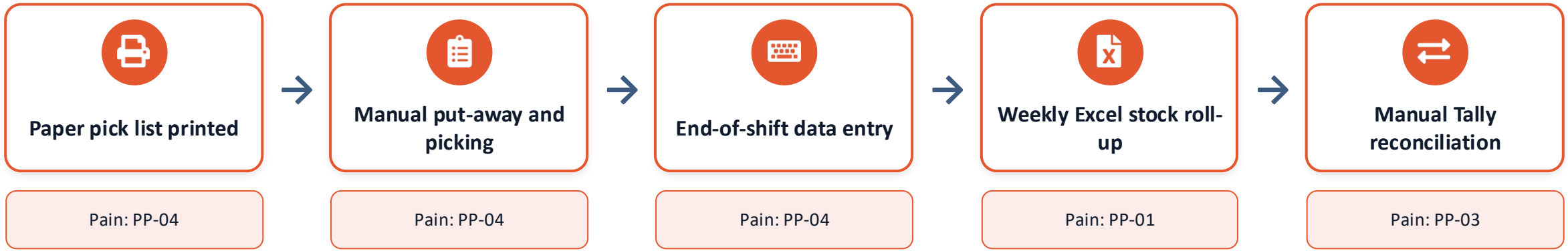
High (5) Medium (4) Low (1)

The common thread is manual capture and no single source of truth. PP-04 (no barcodes) drives inventory accuracy, so it became a mandatory RFP requirement.

Today: paper in, spreadsheets everywhere

Current state on LogiTrack Classic. Each step is tagged with the pain point it causes.

Warehouse flow



Procurement flow



Also: no audit trail (PP-02), single server with no failover (PP-08), edit access for every user (PP-09).

Target: scan once, flow everywhere

Future state on the new platform. Each step is tagged with the pain point it resolves.

Warehouse flow

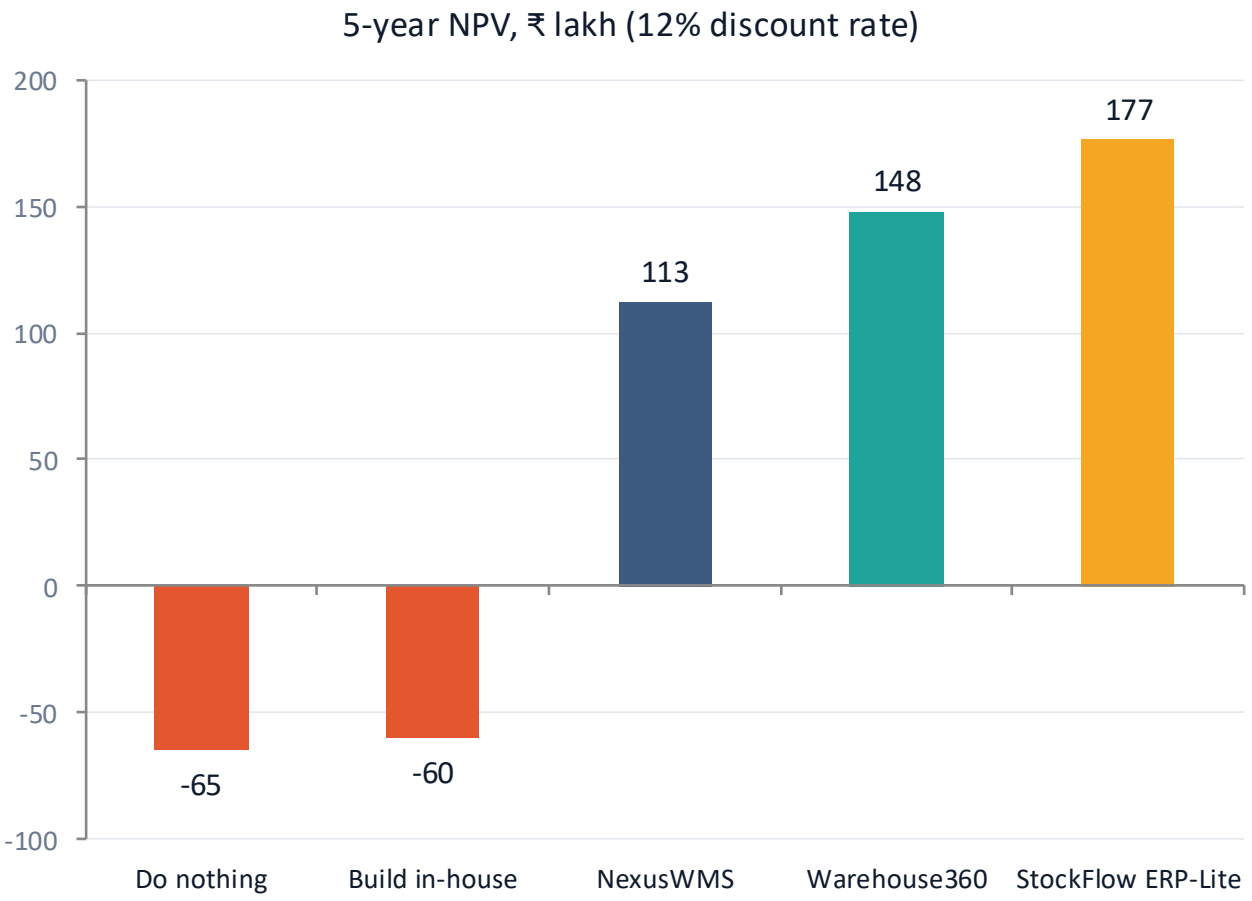


Procurement flow



Also: role-based access with SSO (PP-09) and cloud or hybrid hosting with documented failover (PP-08).

Building does not pay back in five years



Option	Up-front	Run / yr	Payback
Do nothing	0	18	never
Build in-house	150	35	> 5 yrs
NexusWMS	40	28	1.9 yrs
Warehouse360	25	18	**1.5 yrs**
StockFlow ERP-Lite	12	9	1.2 yrs

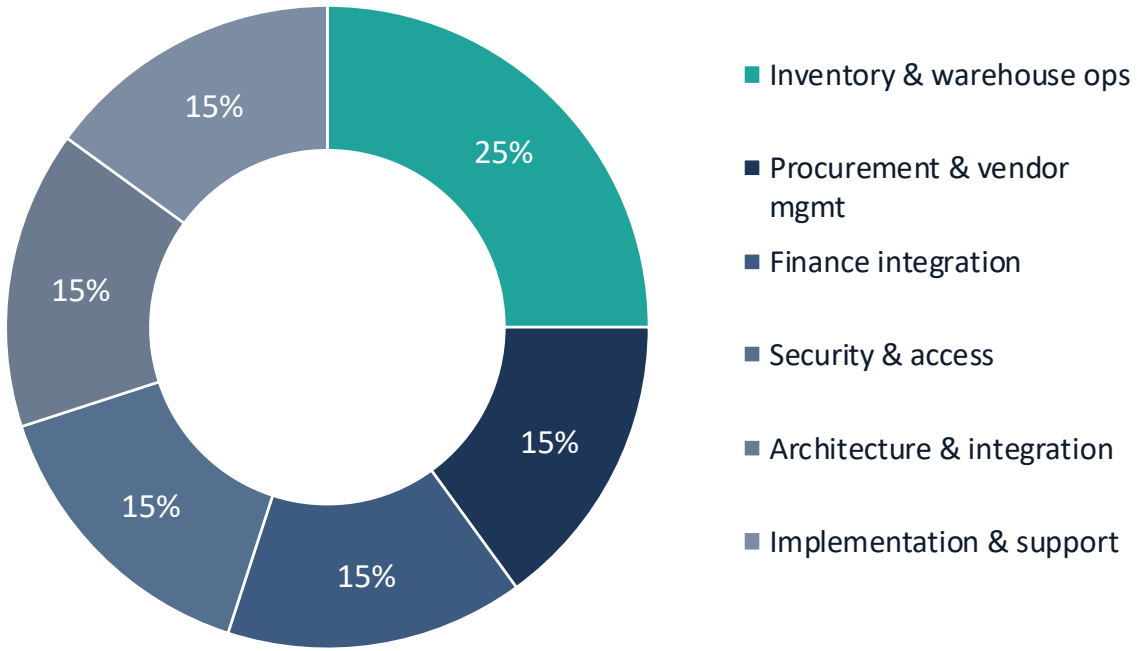
₹ lakh. Up-front and run cost per year.

Every vendor pays back inside two years; the build does not pay back in five. On cost alone, StockFlow wins, which is why price cannot decide this alone.

Illustrative BA estimates from a market scan. Modeled, not vendor-quoted.

Defining 'good' before talking to vendors

RFP evaluation weights

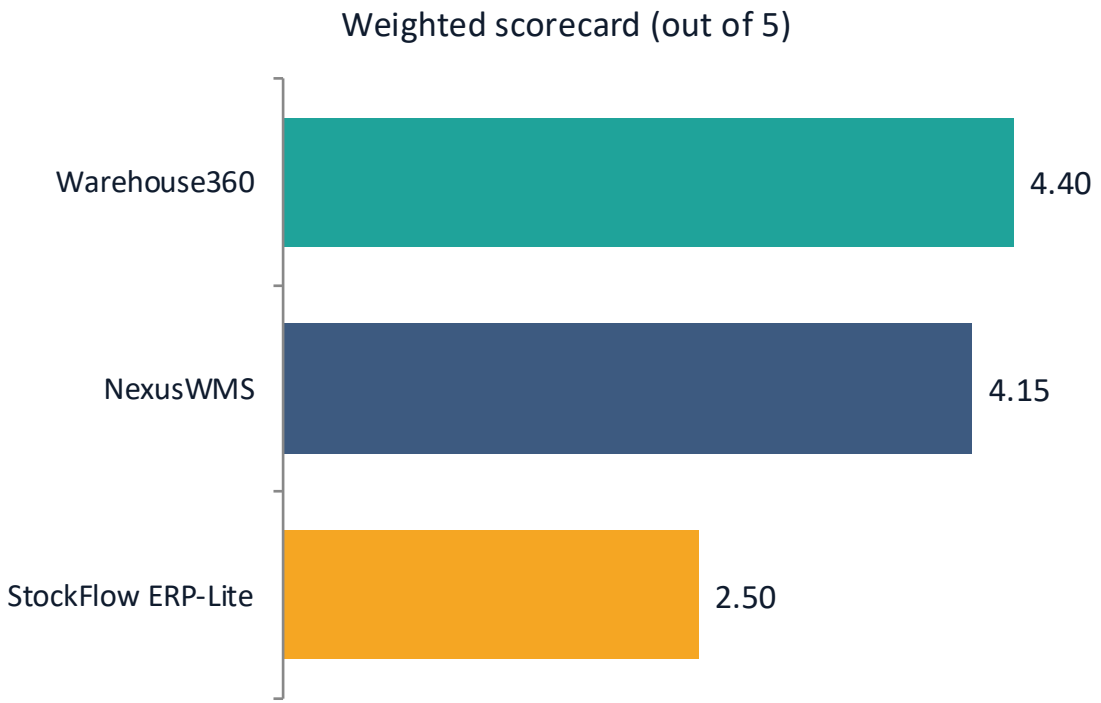


24 requirements: 20 mandatory, 4 desirable

18 trace straight to a pain point; the rest are vendor-qualification gates

Price stays out of the weighted score so it cannot crowd out fit. It is reviewed as a separate gate.

The cheapest vendor won on cost and still lost



StockFlow

Best NPV (₹176 L) and fastest payback (1.2 yrs), but no native barcode support. That fails mandatory FR-02, so it scores 1 on the 25%-weight category.

Warehouse360

Strongest warehouse fit and two verifiable references. NPV ₹148 L, payback 1.5 yrs.

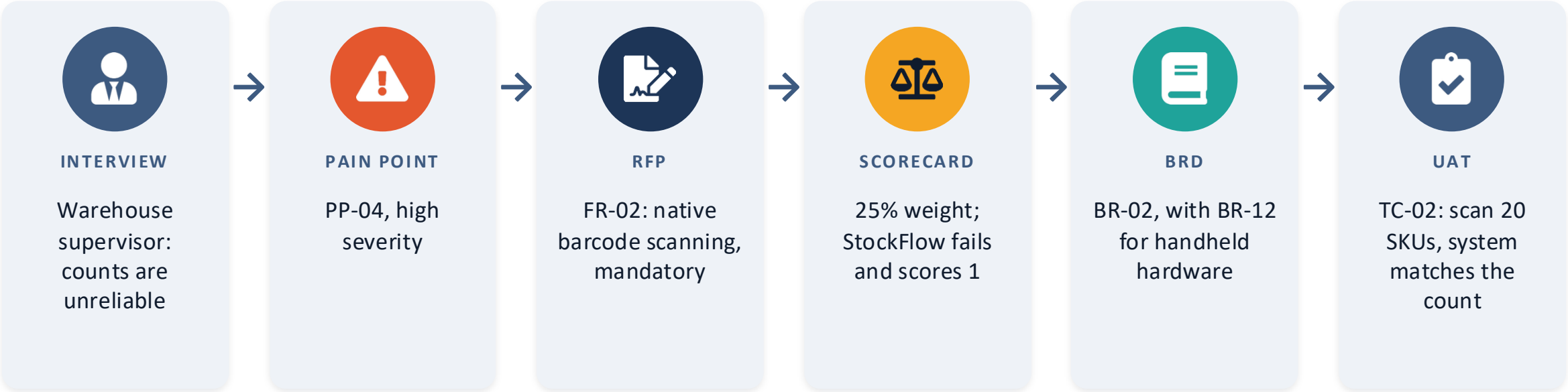
NexusWMS

Stronger on security and architecture, but no verifiable manufacturing reference. Held as the fallback.

Recommendation: Warehouse360, with NexusWMS as fallback

Every need survives from interview to test

One thread, followed end to end: the warehouse floor still runs on paper.



13

business requirements, each with a test case

10

vendor-qualification items verified in due diligence

24 of 24

RFP requirements have a verification path

Ready for go-live: tested, governed, phased

UAT

100%
high-priority tests passed

13 test cases, every high-priority case passed. 4 defects found, 3 closed on retest, 1 low-severity item deferred with a workaround.

Risk register

9 of 9
highest risk score

8 risks scored likelihood times impact. Highest: data migration (9 of 9), then vendor pricing and user adoption (6).

RACI

1
accountable owner per activity

14 activities across 8 roles with exactly one accountable owner per row, so decision rights are settled before sign-off.

Rollout

3
go-live phases

Phased go-live: Bhiwadi first, the other warehouses two weeks later, then the plants. Floor training on real handhelds and week-one hypercare.

What I would do differently

1

Add real stakeholder conflict

My interviews align too cleanly. A live project would force trade-offs between Operations and Finance.

2

Replace estimates with evidence

Costs and benefits are modeled. Real vendor quotes and benchmarks would test them.

3

Plan risk from day one

I added the risk register and RACI after a review. They belong in the first draft.

SKILLS ON SHOW

- Stakeholder discovery
- Requirements and traceability
- NPV and payback modeling
- Weighted vendor evaluation
- UAT and risk management
- Change and rollout planning

The supporting documents

This deck is the summary. Each document below holds the full detail.

1. **Current-State Assessment**
   Interviews and pain-point catalogue
2. **Business Case and CBA**
   Excel model with live formulas
3. **RFP Document**
   24 weighted requirements
4. **Vendor Scorecard**
   Weighted scoring and memo
5. **BRD**
   13 business requirements
6. **Traceability Matrix (RTM)**
   Need to requirement to test
7. **UAT Plan and Sign-off**
   Test cases, defects, memo
8. **Change Management Plan**
   Training and communications
9. **RACI and Risk Register**
   Decision rights and 8 risks

Nupur Sharma

A self-directed simulation built to practise full-lifecycle business analysis.